

MORNING BRIEFING — SUNDAY 21 JUNE 2026

Generated: **06:30 BST** | London pre-open briefing | Next open: Monday 22 June 2026

Context: US markets closed Thu 19 Jun (Juneteenth) & Sat 20 Jun — last US session: **Thu 18 Jun**. European last session: **Fri 19 Jun**. Asian last session: **Fri 20 Jun**.

Data collected approximately 05:45–06:30 BST.

2. IMPORTANT NEWS

Fed holds at 3.50-3.75% but dot plot flips to median hike in 2026 — Warsh opens hawkish chapter

[CNBC / Advisor Perspectives / TradingKey](#) — 17 Jun 2026

The FOMC voted unanimously to hold rates at 3.50-3.75%. New Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first meeting produced a dramatically shorter policy statement that removed all language signalling a bias toward cuts. The revised dot plot shows nine members now project at least one hike in 2026, eight project no change, and only one still expects a cut. Median year-end rate projection: 3.8%. Market impact: rate-hike probability repriced sharply higher; DXY surged toward 101; front-end yields jumped.

US-Iran Geneva talks cancelled — JD Vance cancels Burgenstock trip as ceasefire framework wobbles

[Deccan Herald / Outlook India / Wikipedia](#) — 19-20 Jun 2026

Scheduled US-Iran talks at the Burgenstock resort near Geneva were called off at short notice after Switzerland confirmed the meeting would not proceed. US Vice President JD Vance cancelled travel. The collapse raises uncertainty over the fragile 60-day ceasefire and the 14-point MoU framework that includes a nuclear negotiation roadmap and the Strait of Hormuz reopening. Brent crude rose on the news.

US ends Iran blockade — Hormuz reopening begins under ceasefire MoU framework

[TheStreet / CNBC](#) — 18 Jun 2026

On Thursday, the US announced an end to the Iran blockade as part of the ceasefire MoU, sending oil lower and lifting risk assets. The Nasdaq rallied 1.91% and the Russell 2000 outperformed. However, the subsequent Geneva cancellation on Friday partially reversed the geopolitical de-escalation narrative, leaving energy markets in a tug-of-war between supply relief and political fragility.

ECB raises rates to 2.25%; Bank of England holds at 3.75% — policy divergence re-emerges

[Forex.com / Reuters](#) — Week of 16 Jun 2026

The ECB raised its key rate to 2.25% while the BoE held at 3.75%. Both moves were in-line with consensus. The combined impact on EUR/USD was modest but GBP underperformed (FTSE 100 -1.0%) as BoE's hold disappointed sterling bulls. EUR/USD traded around 1.143 and GBP/USD around 1.340. The divergence between a hiking ECB and a potentially hiking Fed compresses the EUR/USD rate differential argument.

European Commission schedules €7bn EU-Bond auction on 22 June — H1 funding sprint closing out

[European Commission press corner](#) — Jun 2026

The EC confirmed an up-to-€7bn 3-leg auction on Monday 22 June as the final H1 issuance, bringing total H1 2026 EU-Bond volume to approximately €98.8bn against a €100bn target. The preceding syndicated deal on 10 June raised €8bn with €160bn in orders. SSA demand remains exceptionally strong. Monday's auction anchors the European primary calendar and will set the tone for the week.

3. EUROPEAN FUTURES — PRE-OPEN

European equity futures (FESX, FDAX, FFCH, FTSE Z) trade electronically from approximately 17:00 BST Sunday. This report is generated at 06:30 BST — futures markets are not yet open. Implied open is estimated from last closes and overnight signals.

CONTRACT	LAST CLOSE (FRI 19 JUN)	LAST % CHG	EXPECTED OPEN BIAS	KEY DRIVER
Euro STOXX 50 (FESX)	6,302	−0.3%	Mildly Positive	US Thu rally offset by Iran ceasefire uncertainty
DAX (FDAX)	n/a	+0.4%	Mildly Positive	Defense stocks resilient; US chip recovery positive
CAC 40 (FFCH)	n/a	+0.4%	Mildly Positive	Luxury names tracking US session; geopolitical risk cap
FTSE 100 (Z)	n/a	−1.0%	Cautious	GBP resilient post-BoE hold; oil price volatility
US Futures (for context)				
S&P 500 (ES)	7,500.58	+1.08%	Flat/Positive	Iran deal fragility, no catalyst until Mon open
Nasdaq 100 (NQ)	26,517.93	+1.91%	Positive	Chip momentum, AI capex cycle intact

4. YESTERDAY'S CLOSES — EUROPEAN INDICES (FRI 19 JUN 2026)

Note: Saturday 20 June is not a trading day. European markets last traded Friday 19 June 2026.

INDEX	LEVEL	% CHANGE	SESSION NOTE
Euro STOXX 50	6,302	−0.3%	Paused six-day winning streak; Geneva cancellation weighed
STOXX Europe 600	636	−0.2%	Broad retreat on geopolitical uncertainty
DAX 40	n/a	+0.4%	Defense names supported; near 52-week highs
CAC 40	n/a	+0.4%	Luxury and industrials firmer
FTSE 100	n/a	−1.0%	BoE hold disappointed; energy stocks pulled back

DAX, CAC 40, FTSE 100 closing levels not confirmed via live feed this session. % changes sourced from Saxo/CNBC market data. Verify on Bloomberg or Refinitiv before use.

5. US MARKETS — LAST SESSION (THU 18 JUN 2026)

US markets closed Friday 19 Jun (Juneteenth National Independence Day). Last US session: Thursday 18 June 2026.

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE	% CHANGE
S&P 500	7,500.58	+80 pts	+1.08%
Nasdaq Composite	26,517.93	+496 pts	+1.91%
Dow Jones Industrial Average	51,564.70	+72 pts	+0.14%
Russell 2000	n/a	↑ outperformed	n/a

Session tone: Decisively risk-on, driven by two catalysts — the US announcement of an end to the Iran blockade (Strait of Hormuz reopening begins) and a relief rally following the FOMC decision on Wednesday, where markets had initially sold off before recovering. The Nasdaq led, up nearly 2%, as semiconductor and AI-linked names rebounded sharply from the Fed-triggered sell-off on 17 June.

Leaders: Semiconductors / AI chips, defence, small-caps (Russell 2000 outperformed on Iran deal relief).

Laggards: Defensive sectors (utilities, staples) underperformed as risk appetite returned.

Key takeaway: Markets absorbed the hawkish Warsh-era dot plot and rotated into cyclicals and technology on geopolitical relief. The recovery was broad but the weekend Geneva cancellation introduces headline risk for Monday's open.

6. ASIAN MARKETS — LAST SESSION (FRI 20 JUN 2026)

INDEX	LEVEL	% CHANGE	NOTE
Nikkei 225	71,250	+0.28%	Modest gains; chip recovery from US Thu session; yen stable
Hang Seng	CLOSED	—	Hong Kong public holiday — Friday 20 June 2026
Shanghai Composite	~4,090	−0.43%	Last traded Thu 18 Jun; Dragon Boat Festival holiday Fri 19 Jun
CSI 300	~4,748	see note	June 2026 monthly average; last traded Thu 18 Jun
Kospi	n/a	n/a	Data not confirmed for Fri 20 Jun

Overall tone: Mixed with a mild positive bias in Japan. Multiple markets reduced by holiday closures (Hong Kong, Mainland China delayed re-opening). The Nikkei held near its elevated levels as the Iran ceasefire framework provided a backdrop of cautious optimism, though the Strait of Hormuz reopening narrative is the principal supportive factor for Japanese energy-importing equities.

Key driver: Geopolitical news flow (Iran framework, Hormuz reopening) and semiconductor momentum from Wall Street. USD/JPY held broadly stable, limiting currency drag on Nikkei exporters.

7. COMMODITIES

COMMODITY	LEVEL	CHANGE	AS OF	COMMENT
Brent Crude	~\$80.00/bbl	+0.8%	Fri 19 Jun	Rose after Geneva cancellation reversed Hormuz-reopening relief; on track for –10% weekly decline from conflict peak
WTI Crude	\$77.33/bbl	+0.96%	Fri 19 Jun	Supported by Iran uncertainty; Hormuz reopening partially in price
Gold (spot)	\$4,153/oz	–0.82%	Sat 20 Jun	Pulled back as risk appetite improved post-Hormuz; still elevated on safe-haven demand from geopolitics and hawkish Fed
Copper (LME)	~\$6.50/lb	—	Mid-Jun	Near monthly highs; risk appetite improvement from Iran MoU and AI infrastructure build-out driving demand outlook
Natural Gas (TTF/Henry Hub)	n/a	n/a	—	Data not confirmed this session; Hormuz reopening has LNG supply implications

8. RATES & FX

RATES

INSTRUMENT	LEVEL	MOVE
US 10Y Treasury	4.44%	+
German 10Y Bund	2.90%	-
US-Germany Spread	~154 bps	—
Fed Funds Rate	3.50–3.75%	Held (17 Jun)
ECB Deposit Rate	2.25%	+25bps hike
BoE Base Rate	3.75%	Held

FX

PAIR	LEVEL	DIRECTION
EUR/USD	1.1430	— (range-bound)
GBP/USD	1.3400	↓ post-BoE hold
DXY (USD Index)	~101.0	↑ hawkish Fed
USD/JPY	n/a	n/a

Context: The DXY pushed toward 101, its highest since May 2025, driven by hawkish Warsh-era signals. The largest gains were against GBP and CHF. EUR/USD held above 1.14 as the ECB hiked to 2.25%, compressing the dollar's rate advantage slightly. German Bund yields fell toward 2.9%, their lowest since mid-March, as investors fled to safety on the Iran geopolitical flare-up. The US 10Y yield rose near 4.49% post-FOMC on Wednesday before partially retracing to 4.44% by Thursday's close.

9. DCM — PRIMARY BOND MARKET

YESTERDAY'S ISSUANCES (FRI 19 JUN & WEEK TO 19 JUN)

ISSUER	SECTOR	SIZE	CCY	MATURITY	SPREAD / CPN	NOTES
European Commission	SSA	€8bn	EUR	Multi-tranche	n/a	6th syndicated deal 2026; €160bn orderbook. Priced 10 Jun.
Corporate EUR IG	Various	n/a	EUR	—	n/a	Specific deal data unavailable; market broadly open
Corporate HY	Various	n/a	EUR/ USD	—	n/a	n/a this session

PIPELINE / EXPECTED THIS WEEK

ISSUER / DEAL	TYPE	SIZE	DATE	DETAIL
European Commission EU-Bond	SSA / Sovereign	Up to €7bn	Mon 22 Jun	3-leg auction + non-competitive offer next day. H1 2026 close-out; ~€91.8bn issued vs €100bn H1 target. Proceeds fund Ukraine, EU defence & competitiveness.
Corporate pipeline	IG / HY	n/a	Wk 22 Jun	Pre-summer window; corporate issuers typically accelerate ahead of July slowdown. Hawkish Fed repricing may cause some to wait for spread clarity.

KEY SPREADS

INDEX	LEVEL (BPS)	MOVE (BPS)	DIRECTION
iTraxx Main (5Y)	n/a	n/a	Near-record tights (general market description)
iTraxx Crossover (5Y)	n/a	n/a	Near-record tights
CDX IG (5Y)	n/a	n/a	n/a
Avg Euro Corp IG Spread	n/a	n/a	n/a

iTraxx and CDX live spread data not accessible this session. Bloomberg/Refinitiv required for real-time levels. Market descriptions from Wellington and S&P Dow Jones indicate spreads near cyclical tights as of June 2026.

COMMENTARY

The primary market window opens for the week with the European Commission's H1 close-out auction on Monday — up to €7bn across three tranches. With €160bn of demand on the prior EC syndicated deal, SSA investor appetite remains exceptional and the auction should clear well, though higher base rates (Fed hike risk, ECB at 2.25%) will price in new supply accordingly.

Corporate issuance is expected to be moderate this week. Issuers face a crossroads: act before the summer liquidity squeeze or wait for clarity on whether the Fed will hike. The geopolitical backdrop (Iran ceasefire fragility) keeps risk premia marginally elevated in HY and crossover names exposed to energy and Middle East logistics. Financials and IG industrials with near-term refinancing needs will likely keep the window open through this week.

Skew watch: energy names, shipping, and defence-related issuers may command attention given the geopolitical backdrop. The Hormuz reopening, if sustained, would be net positive for transport-heavy credits.

10. ECONOMIC CALENDAR — WEEK OF 22 JUNE 2026

Monday 22 June			
09:00 BST	European Commission EU-Bond Auction (up to €7bn)	H1 close-out; ~€91.8bn issued YTD vs €100bn target	HIGH
All day	No major macro data scheduled (US Juneteenth hangover; light EU calendar)	—	LOW
Tuesday 23 June			
08:15 BST	Eurozone Flash PMI Composite (S&P Global)	Consensus n/a; prior: above 50	HIGH
08:30 BST	UK Flash PMI Composite (S&P Global)	Consensus n/a; growth watch amid BoE hold	HIGH
14:45 BST	US Flash PMI Composite (S&P Global)	Key read on economic health ahead of potential Fed hike	HIGH
Wednesday 24 June			
TBC	German Ifo Business Climate	n/a; key gauge of German corporate sentiment	MED
15:00 BST	US Consumer Confidence (Conference Board)	n/a	MED
Thursday 25 June			
13:30 BST	US Initial Jobless Claims	n/a; labour market health key to Fed hike probability	MED
13:30 BST	US Q1 2026 GDP (final revision)	n/a; confirms or adjusts prior estimates	MED
Friday 27 June			
13:30 BST	US PCE Deflator (May 2026)	n/a; Fed's preferred inflation gauge — critical for hike probability	HIGH

Specific consensus estimates not available this session. Check Investing.com or TradingEconomics for exact times and forecasts. Flash PMI dates are approximate based on typical S&P Global release schedule (3rd Tuesday of month).

11. CORPORATE EVENTS & EARNINGS — WEEK OF 22 JUNE 2026

DATE	REGION	EVENTS	SIGNIFICANCE
Mon 22 Jun	US / Europe	Light earnings day; post-Juneteenth re-open	EC bond auction main event
Tue 23 Jun	US / Europe	~15 earnings reports scheduled (names n/a)	Flash PMI day; sentiment risk
Wed 24 Jun	US / Europe	~16 earnings reports scheduled	German Ifo; consumer confidence
Thu 25 Jun	US / Europe	~26 earnings reports scheduled	Busiest day; GDP and jobless claims
Fri 27 Jun	US	Nike (NKE) expected (FY Q4)	PCE deflator also due; consumer bellwether

Specific company names for Tue–Thu earnings not confirmed this session. Check Yahoo Finance earnings calendar or EarningsWhispers for individual company schedules. Nike FY Q4 is the marquee US retail/consumer name this week.

12. STOCKS TO WATCH — MONDAY 22 JUNE 2026

Airbus AIR.PA — Aerospace / Aviation	Iran ceasefire and Hormuz reopening expected to revive Middle East air traffic; narrowbody demand narrative strengthens if diplomatic progress resumes. Watch for any airline capacity announcements from Gulf carriers.	↑ Positive bias
Rolls-Royce RR.L — Aerospace / Defence	Dual exposure: defence engine spending accelerating amid geopolitical tensions and European rearmament; commercial aviation recovery if Hormuz de-escalation holds. FTSE 100 underperformer Friday creates potential catch-up.	↑ Positive bias
Lockheed Martin LMT — Aerospace / Defence (US)	Iran conflict and European rearmament driving multi-year defence order cycle. M&A as a growth lever in sector per PwC. F-35 and missile defence demand elevated. Geopolitical premium still supportive.	↑ Positive bias
Rio Tinto RIO.L / RIO — Metals & Mining	Chinalco partnership to acquire controlling stake in Brazilian aluminium maker CBA (>\$900m deal). Rare earth and base metals exposure benefits from AI/defence infrastructure build. Integration and strategic positioning news expected.	↑ Positive bias (M&A)
Shell SHEL.L — Energy	Brent near \$80; Hormuz reopening trajectory versus Geneva cancellation pullback keeps LNG and oil price in tight range. FTSE 100 heaviest constituent — FTSE underperformance Friday partly energy-driven. Key read for UK market tone Monday.	Neutral — oil range-bound
Nvidia NVDA — AI / Semiconductors (US)	Leading the chip recovery that drove Nasdaq +1.91% on Thursday. AI infrastructure capex cycle intact. Bellwether for risk sentiment Monday. Any Iran-related headline drag on Asian suppliers (TSMC, Samsung) would ripple through.	↑ Positive momentum
Thales HO.PA — Defence Electronics	European defence electronics major; direct beneficiary of EU rearmament drive. EU bond proceeds funding Ukraine and EU defence explicitly. Geopolitical premium well supported. Watch DAX/CAC tone for sector direction.	↑ Positive bias
Maersk (A.P. Moller) MAERSK-B.CO — Shipping	Hormuz reopening critical for Red Sea/Gulf shipping re-routing reversal. Reopening would reduce deviation costs through Suez; freight rates and container pricing impacted. Key watch on Geneva cancellation consequences for shipping lanes.	Binary — Iran news dependent
BNP Paribas BNP.PA — French Banking	ECB hike to 2.25% positive for European bank NIM. French banks also lead European DCM activity — primary market health directly tied to fee income. Watch as proxy for ECB rate path confidence.	↑ Rate hike beneficiary
ArcelorMittal MT — Metals & Steel	Copper at ~\$6.50/lb near highs; steel and industrial metals benefiting from AI infrastructure, European rearmament, and Ukraine reconstruction expectations. Watch Rio Tinto CBA deal for sector M&A read-through.	Neutral — demand vs rate concerns

13. MACRO / CORPORATE / POLITICAL HIGHLIGHTS

MACRO

Fed hawkish regime change (Warsh era)

Dot plot flips from cut to hike. Nine FOMC members project at least one hike in 2026. Markets must price a materially higher terminal rate than priced in March. Front-end rates now pricing ~3.8% median year-end funds rate. Duration risk elevated.

ECB at 2.25%; BoE holds 3.75%

ECB hiked 25bps this week, continuing its normalisation cycle. BoE held in a split vote, disappointing some. GBP underperformed on the hold. EUR/USD range-bound near 1.143 as two central banks tighten at different paces.

Oil de-escalation partially priced

Brent lost roughly 10% from conflict peak as Hormuz reopening entered the narrative. Geneva cancellation on Friday partially reversed the risk-off relief, but oil is structurally lower than conflict highs. Inflation implications for both Fed and ECB.

AI-led capex super-cycle intact

Despite Fed hawkishness, AI infrastructure spending remains the dominant growth driver. Nasdaq outperformance versus DJIA (+1.91% vs +0.14% Thursday) confirms tech-led market leadership. Semiconductor supply chain a key watch.

CORPORATE

Chip sector recovery leads US

Semiconductors drove Nasdaq's 1.91% rebound on Thursday, recovering from the June 4 -4% sell-off (worst Nasdaq day since April 2025). AI chip demand narrative remains the dominant sector theme. Nvidia is the bellwether.

Rio Tinto CBA acquisition (Chinalco)

Rio Tinto partnered with China's Chinalco to acquire a controlling stake in Brazilian aluminium producer CBA in a deal valued at over \$900m. Signals continued mining M&A acceleration and China-Australia corporate re-engagement in base metals.

European defence M&A acceleration

EU rearmament drive is fuelling dealmaking in aerospace and defence. Buyers targeting assets to accelerate modernisation; large conglomerates divesting non-core units; PE building platforms via carve-outs. Airbus, Thales, BAE Systems remain key beneficiaries.

EC H1 bond funding near complete

EC has issued ~€91.8bn in H1 against a €100bn target. Monday's €7bn auction closes out the sprint. Strong investor demand (€160bn on June 10 deal) indicates SSA market is extremely healthy despite higher rates.

POLITICAL / GEOPOLITICAL

Iran ceasefire: fragile but holding

The 14-point MoU framework (including a 60-day ceasefire extension and nuclear negotiation roadmap) is in place but the Geneva talks collapse casts doubt on pace. Strait of Hormuz reopening has begun but could reverse if the ceasefire breaks. This is the single largest geopolitical risk for markets this week.

US-Iran: Vance cancels Switzerland

JD Vance's cancellation is diplomatically significant and sent oil higher on Friday. The ceasefire framework remains nominally in place but political momentum has stalled. The window for a formal nuclear deal is narrowing ahead of the 60-day clock running down.

EU defence and Ukraine funding

The EC's €7bn Monday bond auction explicitly funds Ukraine support and EU defence modernisation — a structural shift in EU fiscal policy. European rearmament is now a multi-year bond supply theme and equity sector catalyst.

14. KEY THEMES — TOP 5 BY HORIZON

TODAY'S TOP 5 (MON 22 JUN)

1. EC €7bn Auction

The H1 close-out bond auction anchors the SSA calendar and sets the tone for investor appetite and spread direction this week.

2. Iran / Hormuz weekend news

Any diplomatic developments over the weekend on the Geneva cancellation will directly move oil, gold, and risk assets at Monday's open.

3. European open after cautious Friday

STOXX 50 -0.3%, FTSE -1.0% Friday — Monday's open tone depends on whether US Thursday momentum or Friday geopolitical caution dominates.

4. Chip / AI sector momentum

Nasdaq +1.91% Thursday needs to be sustained; any negative Asian semiconductor news (TSMC, Samsung) could reverse the move.

5. USD and rate re-pricing

DXY near 101; any Fed speaker commentary Monday will shape whether the hike repricing accelerates or moderates into the week.

THIS WEEK'S TOP 5 (22-27 JUN)

1. Flash PMIs (Tue 23 Jun)

Eurozone, UK, and US composite PMIs will determine whether the hawkish Fed is hiking into growth strength or stagflation — critical for rate path and equities.

2. US PCE Deflator (Fri 27 Jun)

The Fed's preferred inflation gauge for May. An upside surprise would cement the July hike probability; a miss would ease rate expectations sharply.

3. Corporate earnings ramp

26 companies report Thursday alone. Q2 2026 earnings season begins in earnest — first full quarter with Iran war impact embedded in guidance.

4. Iran ceasefire durability

Whether diplomatic contact resumes after Geneva collapse determines oil price trajectory and risk premium across energy-exposed credits and equities.

5. Fed speaker calendar

Multiple FOMC members expected to speak post-decision. Their characterisation of the dot plot flip (hawkish vs conditional) will move front-end rates.

THIS MONTH'S TOP 5 (JUNE 2026)

1. Fed rate path pivot

The shift from cut expectation to hike risk is the defining macro event of June. Markets are repricing duration and credit risk across the curve for the rest of 2026.

2. US-Iran nuclear framework

The 60-day ceasefire clock and nuclear negotiation trajectory determine whether oil normalises at \$70s or returns toward \$90+ if the framework collapses.

3. ECB at 2.25% — next step

With the June hike done, markets focus on whether the ECB pauses at 2.25% or continues. German Bund yields falling to 2.9% suggest the market expects a pause.

4. EU H1 bond funding complete

Post-Monday's auction, the EU's €100bn H1 target is essentially met. The H2 funding plan and size will be published shortly — structural supply driver for EUR rates.

5. AI/semiconductor cycle vs rate risk

The tension between durable AI capex demand (Nasdaq leadership) and rising real rates (Warsh hike risk) is the core portfolio allocation question for Q3 2026.

15. KEY TRENDS TO WATCH

1 DAY — TODAY'S SESSION

Iran weekend headlines

Any diplomatic contact resumption or further deterioration from the Geneva collapse will be the first mover at European open. Watch: oil spot, gold, defence stocks.

European open gap analysis

STOXX 50 closed -0.3% Friday but US closed +1.08% Thursday. The gap between these two last sessions typically resolves at open. Direction: modest positive bias, bounded by geopolitical headline risk.

EC auction result (09:00+ BST)

Bid-to-cover ratio and clearing spread for the EC €7bn deal will set the tone for EUR rates and SSA credit all week. Strong result = risk-on signal for European primary market.

DXY and rate expectations

DXY near 101. If US futures open Sunday evening with the Warsh hike narrative intact, EUR/USD may test 1.14 support. Fed speaker watch all week.

1 WEEK — 22-27 JUNE

PMI data (Tue 23 Jun)

Flash PMIs are the week's key data point. Sub-50 readings in the Eurozone would complicate the ECB's hike narrative and could trigger a Bund rally and EUR weakness.

PCE inflation (Fri 27 Jun)

The Fed's preferred measure. An upside print would push July hike probability above 50% and extend the DXY rally. Equities would face pressure, particularly duration-sensitive tech.

Earnings acceleration (Thu 25 Jun peak)

26 companies report Thursday. Quality of guidance matters more than beats: companies with Iran/energy supply chain exposure are the key read-through for sector rotation.

Oil price range: \$75-\$82 Brent

The Hormuz opening vs Geneva collapse tension keeps Brent in this range. A sustained break above \$82 would reignite inflation concerns; below \$75 confirms de-escalation success.

1 MONTH — JUNE-JULY 2026

Fed July meeting (late July)

The dot plot has opened the door to a July hike. PCE, PMIs, and employment data this month will determine whether the Fed acts at the next FOMC meeting. Most consequential binary for markets.

Iran 60-day ceasefire clock

The MoU framework runs for 60 days. Each week without progress on formalising the nuclear deal increases the risk of ceasefire collapse and an oil price spike into Q3.

Q2 earnings season (July)

Q2 2026 is the first full quarter with Iran war embedded in company results. Margin pressure from energy costs, shipping disruptions, and geopolitical risk will be the key corporate theme in July.

European rearmament fiscal path

Post-EU H1 bond completion, the H2 funding plan and any new defence facility announcements will shape EUR rates and defence equity valuations through July-August.

Summer liquidity thinning

From mid-July, European market liquidity drops materially. Issuers and investors will front-load activity in late June. This creates short-term bid for risk assets (primary market demand) and longer-term volatility risk when liquidity dries up.

SOURCES

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- Wellington Management — Credit spread environment 2026
- EarningsWhispers / Kiplinger — Week of 22 Jun earnings calendar

Data collected automatically between approximately 05:45 and 06:30 BST on Sunday 21 June 2026. Several data points marked n/a where live confirmation was not possible via web search (specific DAX/CAC/FTSE closing levels, iTraxx/CDX spread levels, natural gas price, individual earnings names for the week). Verify all figures against Bloomberg, Refinitiv, or primary exchange data before making any investment or trading decision. This report is informational only and does not constitute financial advice.